IMS

# How to use IMS

The staff guide for the office and the phone: step by step, with pictures.

FOR

Administrators, supervisors and field staff

VERSION

November 3, 2026

INSIDE

Getting started · Stock · Equipment · Counts · Forms, reports and settings · The phone app · Quick reference

HOW TO READ IT

Words in **bold** are exactly what you see on screen. Pictures use sample data, like `TOOL-0001`.

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# How to use IMS

IMS (Inventory Management System) tracks two kinds of things:

- **Stock**: things you count and give out, like gloves, pants or cable ties. IMS keeps the number on hand at each location.
- **Assets**: equipment you lend out and get back, like drills or laptops. Each one has its own tag (like TOOL-0001) and its own history.

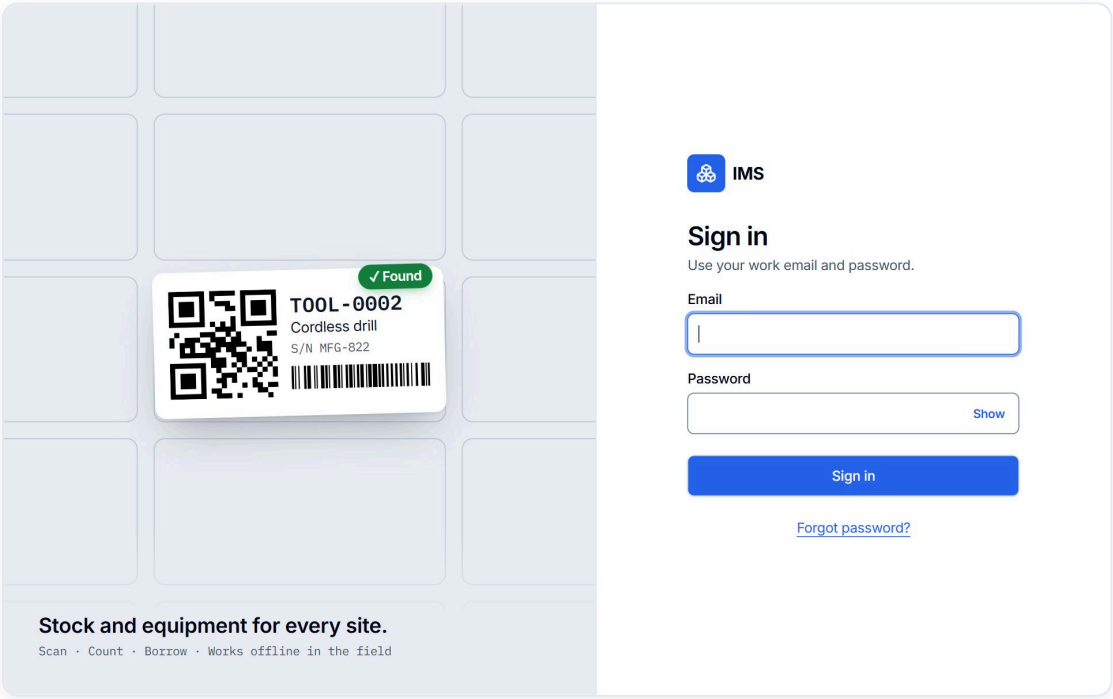
It works on a phone, tablet or computer. Words in **bold** are exactly what you see on screen. Pictures use sample data.

PART 1

## Getting started

### 1. Sign in

1. Open the IMS link your company gave you.
2. Type your **Email** and **Password**.
3. Press **Sign in**.




Sign-in page

**Forgot your password?** Ask an administrator. They open **Users**, choose **Reset link** on your name, and send you the link. Open it, type a new password twice (at least 10 characters), then press **Save new password**.

**Warning:** 5 wrong passwords in 15 minutes lock your email for 15 minutes. An administrator's **Reset link** unlocks it straight away.

## 2. Who can do what

| You are | You can |
|---|---|
| **Administrator** | Everything, at every location, plus **Users** and the **Audit log** |
| **Supervisor** | At your locations: add items and assets, receive, issue and transfer stock, lend and take back equipment, run and approve counts |
| **Field staff** | Count with your phone (works without internet) and send borrow requests |

## 3. Stock or asset? Decide before you add an item

Ask: **"Do I need to know *which one*?"**

| Stock | Asset |
|---|---|
| No. Any pair of pants is the same | Yes. *This* laptop went to Juan and is due back Friday |
| Kept as a number: "3 pair at MAIN-WH" | Each unit has its own tag: LAP-0001, LAP-0002… |
| Comes in with **Receive** | Comes in with **Add assets** |
| Goes out with **Issue** (it doesn't come back) | Goes out with **Borrow** and comes back with **Return** |

**Warning:** You can't change this later. If you pick the wrong one, make a new item with a new SKU.

## 4. Finding your way

**On a computer**, the menu is on the left:

- **Dashboard**, **Stock**, **Assets**, **Counts**, **Borrowing**, **Documents**, **Reports**
- Under **Settings**: **Locations**, **Units & categories**, **Users**, **Audit log** (you only see what your role allows)
- At the bottom: your name (your **Me** page) and **Sign out**

**On a phone**, the bar at the bottom has **Dashboard**, **Stock**, **Scan**, **Assets** and **More** (everything else).

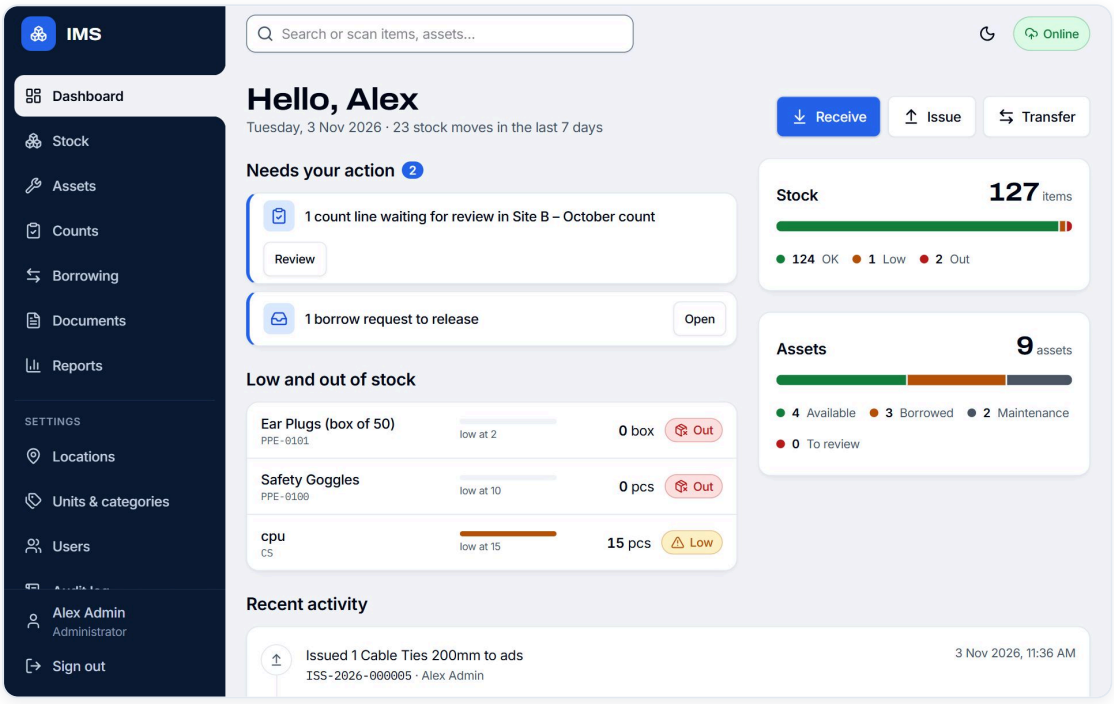
At the top of every page:

- **Search box**: type or scan a name, SKU, asset tag, serial or barcode.
- **Sun / moon button**: switches between light and dark.
- **Online** pill: green when IMS can reach the server.

### The dashboard

The **Dashboard** opens when you sign in.

- **Needs your action** is your to-do list: counts to review, borrow requests, overdue loans and failed forms. Clear it and your day is done.
- **Low and out of stock** shows what needs reordering.
- **Recent activity** shows the latest stock moves, loans and returns, 10 at a time (use **‹ ›** to see older ones).
- **Receive**, **Issue** and **Transfer** buttons are at the top right.



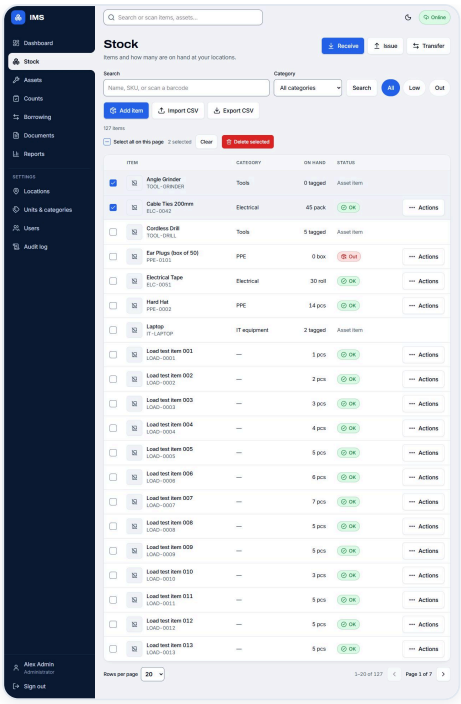

Dashboard

> **Tip:** Receive, Issue, Transfer and Borrow all use the same 4 steps: **Where** → **What** → **Who** → **Review**. The **Next** button names the next step (like **Next: What**). Nothing changes until you press the confirm button on the last step.

### Lists: pages, rows and selecting

Every list (**Stock**, **Assets**, **Counts**, **Borrowing**, **Documents**, **Reports**, **Audit log**) has the same bar at the bottom:

- **Rows per page**: 20, 50, 100 or **All** (Recent activity starts at 10).
- **1–20 of 127**: which rows you're looking at.
- **‹** and **›**: the previous and next page. Your search and filters stay when you change page.




Rows per page and selecting rows

**Remove things added by mistake** (Stock, Assets, Locations, Users; if you're allowed to manage them):

1. Tick the box on each row, or **Select all on this page**.
2. Press **Delete selected**, read the message, then press **Delete**.
3. A message says what was deleted and what was hidden.

> **Tip:** Only records that were never used are deleted. Anything with history (stock moves, loans, counts, forms) is **hidden** instead, so reports and forms stay correct: items and locations become inactive, people can't sign in any more, and equipment is **Retired**. You can't delete your own account.

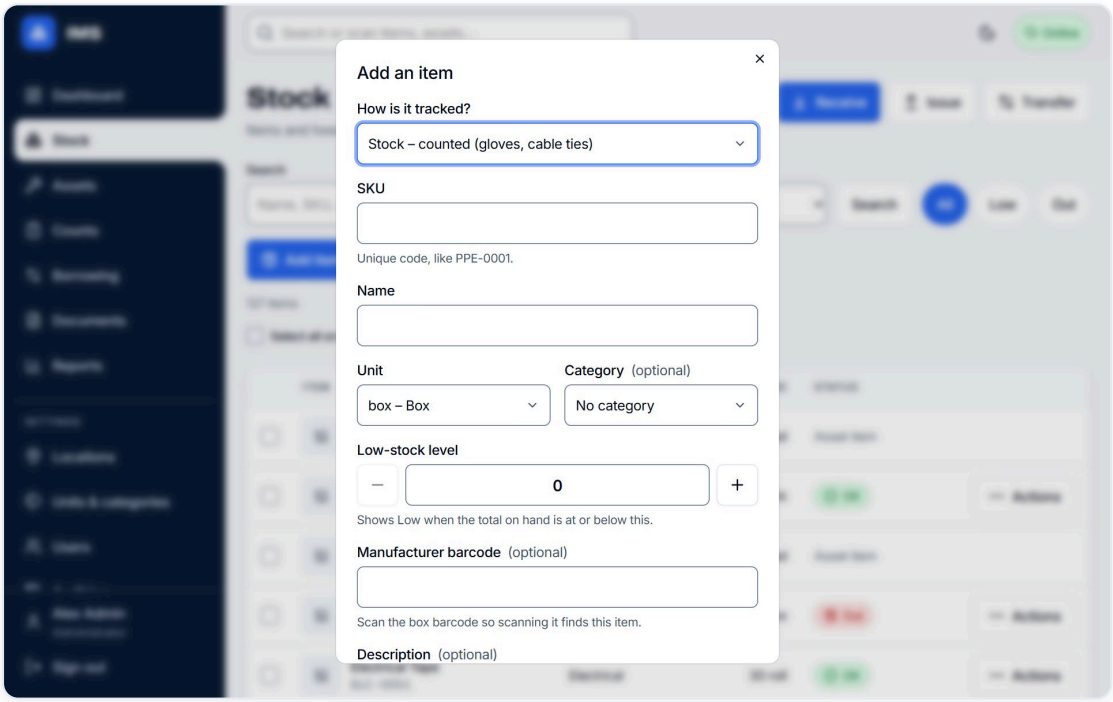
PART 2

# Office: stock

## 5. Add items

### One item

1. Open **Stock** and press **Add item** (below the search box).
2. **How is it tracked?**: choose **Stock** or **Asset** (see section 3).
3. Fill in **SKU** (a unique code, like `PPE-0001`), **Name** and **Unit**.
4. Optional: **Category**, **Low-stock level** (stock only), **Manufacturer barcode**, **Description**.
5. Optional: **Photo**. Choose a picture (on a phone you can take one) so everyone knows exactly which item it is.
6. Press **Add item**.




Add an item

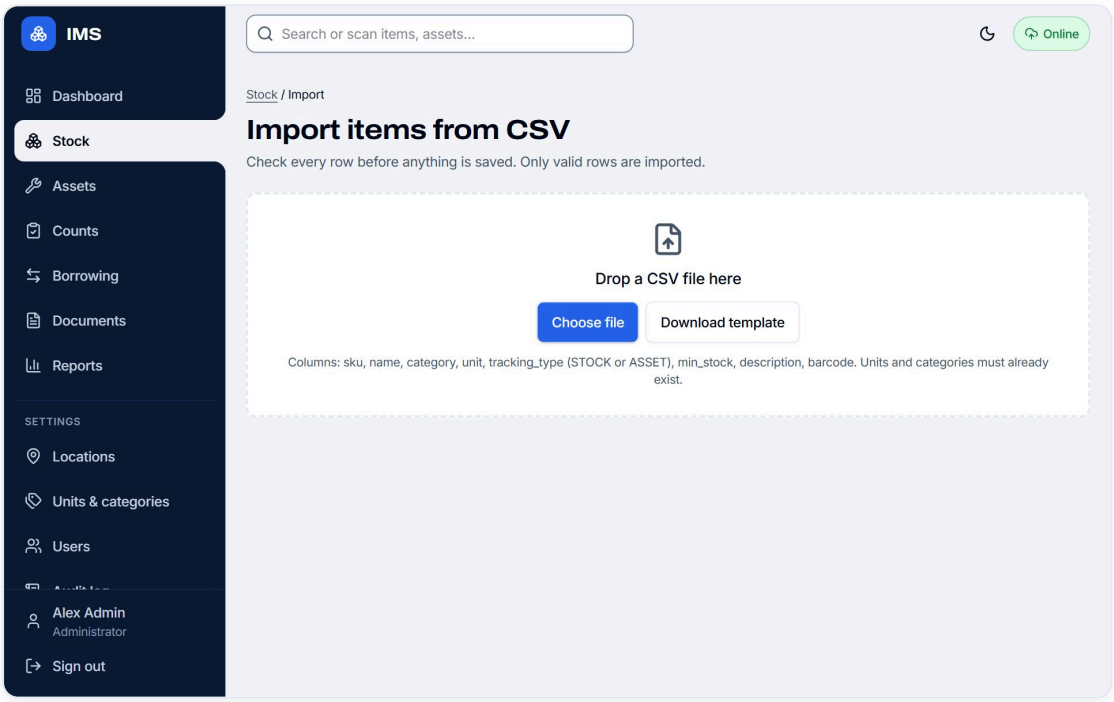
**Tip:** To add or change a photo later, open the item and press **Add photo** or **Change photo** (or **Remove**). Photos also show as small pictures in the **Stock** list.

### Many items at once (CSV file)

1. Open **Stock** and press **Import CSV**.
2. Press **Download template** and fill it in with Excel (save it as CSV).

3. Press **Choose file** and pick your file.
4. Check the list: rows with a problem are red and say what's wrong. Fix them in the file and choose it again, or import only the good rows.
5. Press **Import … valid rows**.

| Column | What to put | Required |
|---|---|---|
| `sku` | Unique code, like `PPE-0001` | Yes |
| `name` | Item name | Yes |
| `unit` | A unit code that already exists, like `pcs` | Yes |
| `tracking_type` | `STOCK` or `ASSET` | Yes |
| `category` | A category that already exists, like `PPE` | No |
| `min_stock` | Low-stock level (stock only) | No |
| `description` | Any detail | No |
| `barcode` | The manufacturer's barcode number | No |




Import items from a CSV file

**Warning:** Units and categories must exist before you import. Add them first in **Units & categories** (section 21).

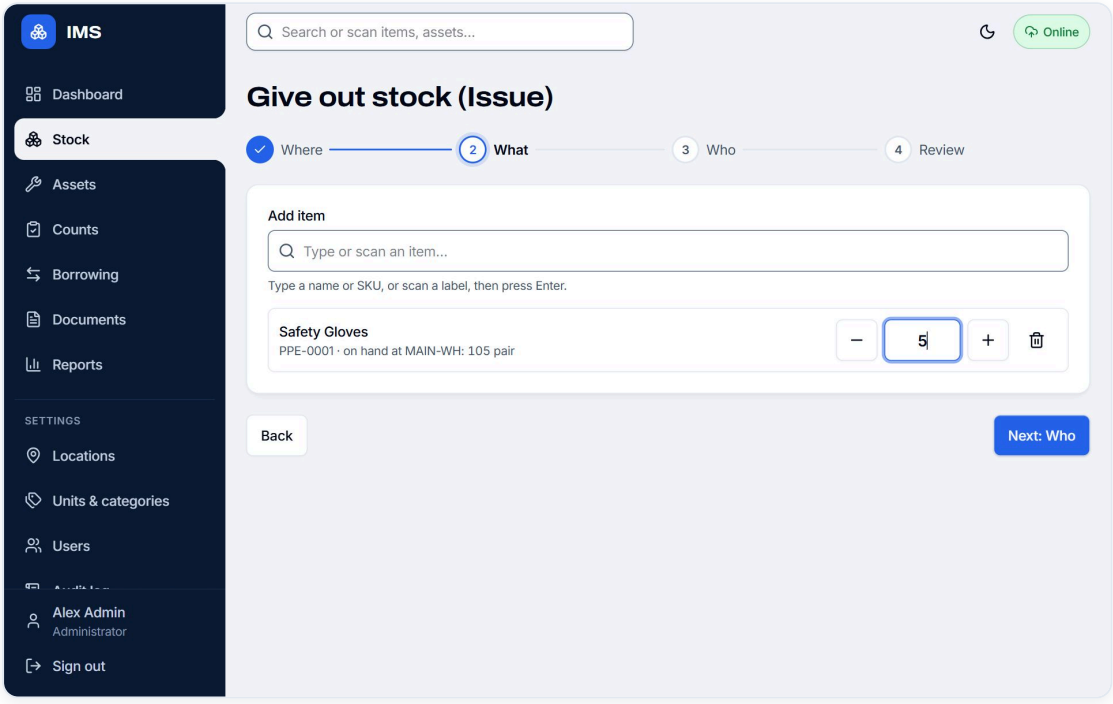
## 6. Receive stock (a delivery came in)

1. **Dashboard** → **Receive**.
2. **Receive at**: pick the location → **Next**.

3. **Add item**: scan or type the name or SKU, press Enter, then type how many. Repeat for each item → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Received from** (supplier) and **Delivery note / PO number** → **Next**.
5. Check the numbers → **Confirm receipt**.

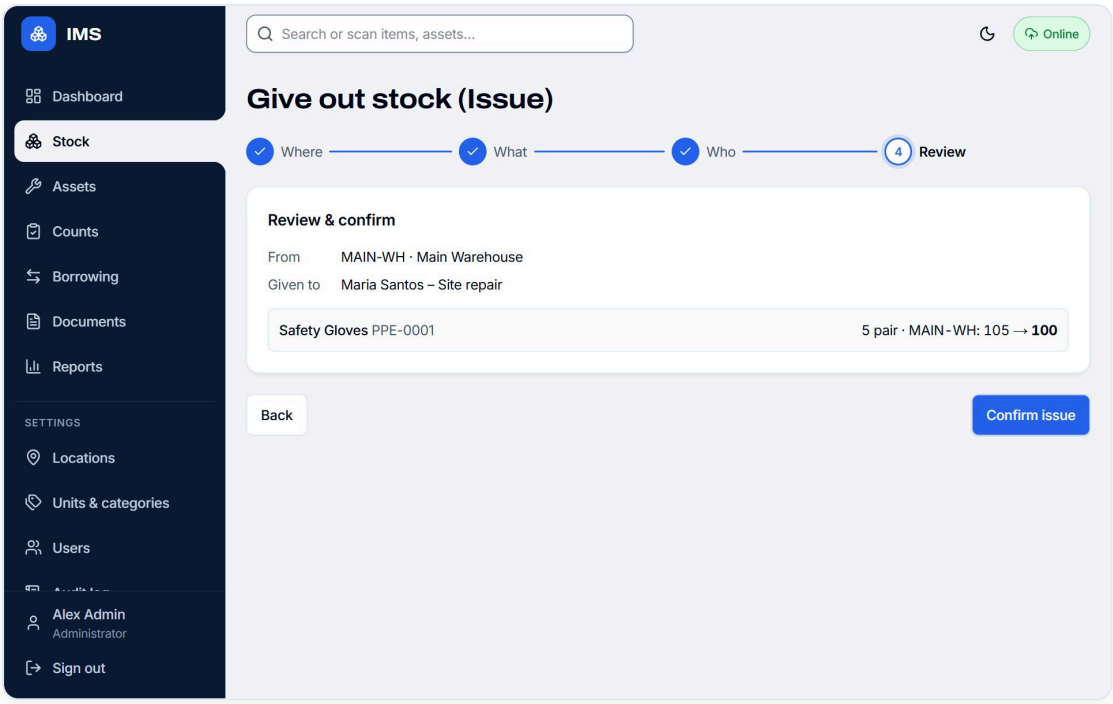
## 7. Give out stock (Issue)

1. **Dashboard** → **Issue**.
2. **Issue from**: pick the location → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.




Issue, step 2: add items and quantities

4. **Given to** and **Purpose** (work order or reason) → **Next**.
5. Check the before → after numbers → **Confirm issue**.




Issue, step 4: review and confirm

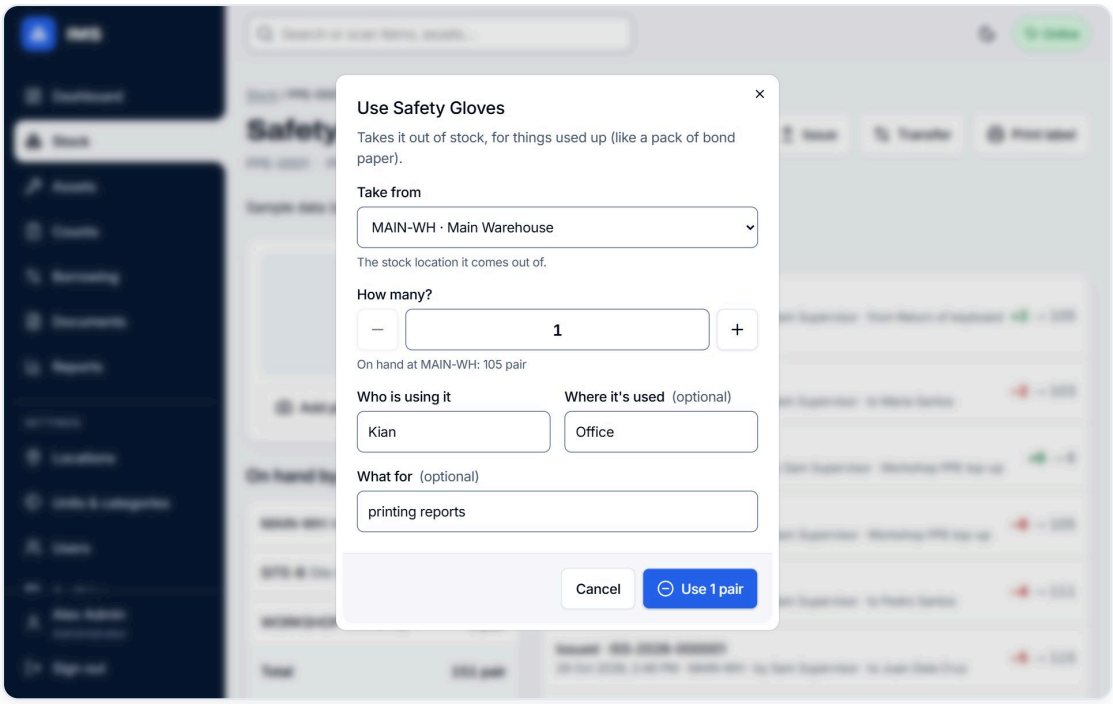
6. Press **Print** or **Download PDF** to get the **Stock Issuance form** for signing.

> **Tip:** If you ask for more than is on hand, IMS says how many are left (like "Only 3 pcs left at MAIN-WH"). Lower the quantity or pick another location.

## Use stock (quick: things used up)

For things used up in the office, like a pack of bond paper:

1. Open the item (or **Actions** → **Use** in the **Stock** list) → **Use**.
2. **Take from**: the stock location it comes out of (only if you have more than one).
3. **How many?** (starts at 1).
4. **Who is using it** (starts with your name; change it, e.g. to Kian) and, optionally, **Where it's used** (e.g. Office) and **What for**.
5. Press **Use …** (like **Use 1 pack**). Stock goes down by that much.




Use: who, where and how many

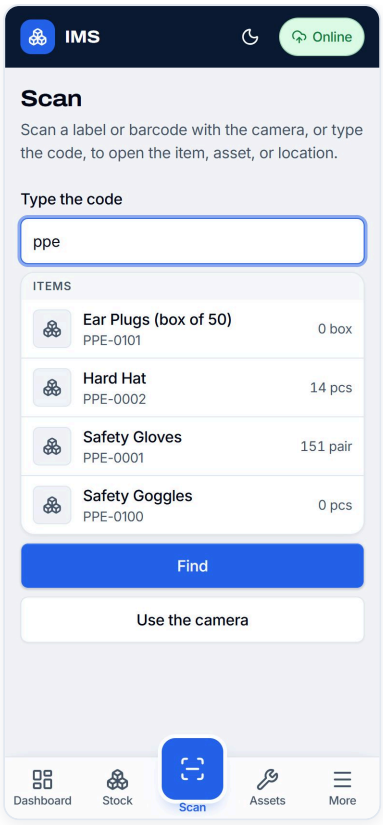
**Tip: Use** is recorded as an issue to the person using it, with the purpose "Used at Office: ...", so it shows in the item's movements, Recent activity, reports and counts. To give stock to someone for a job, with a signed form, use **Issue**.

## 8. Move stock to another location (Transfer)

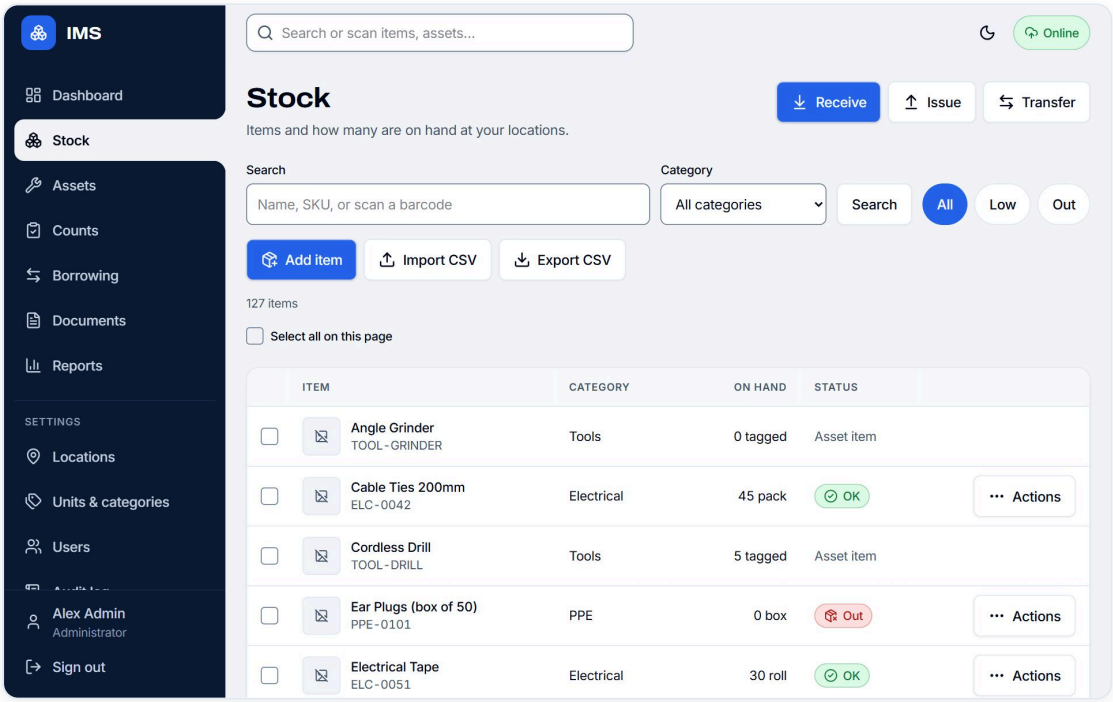
1. **Dashboard** → **Transfer**.
2. **From** and **To** → **Next**.
3. Add the items and how many → **Next**.
4. Optional: **Reason** → **Next**.
5. **Confirm transfer**, then print the **Transmittal form**.

## 9. Find anything

- **Search box** at the top: type or scan a name, SKU, asset tag, serial or barcode, then press Enter.
- **Scan** → **Type code instead**: start typing, even part of a SKU or name. Matching items, assets and locations appear under the box; tap one to open it.
- **Stock**: tap **Low** or **Out** to see what needs reordering, or pick a category.




Scan: suggestions while typing

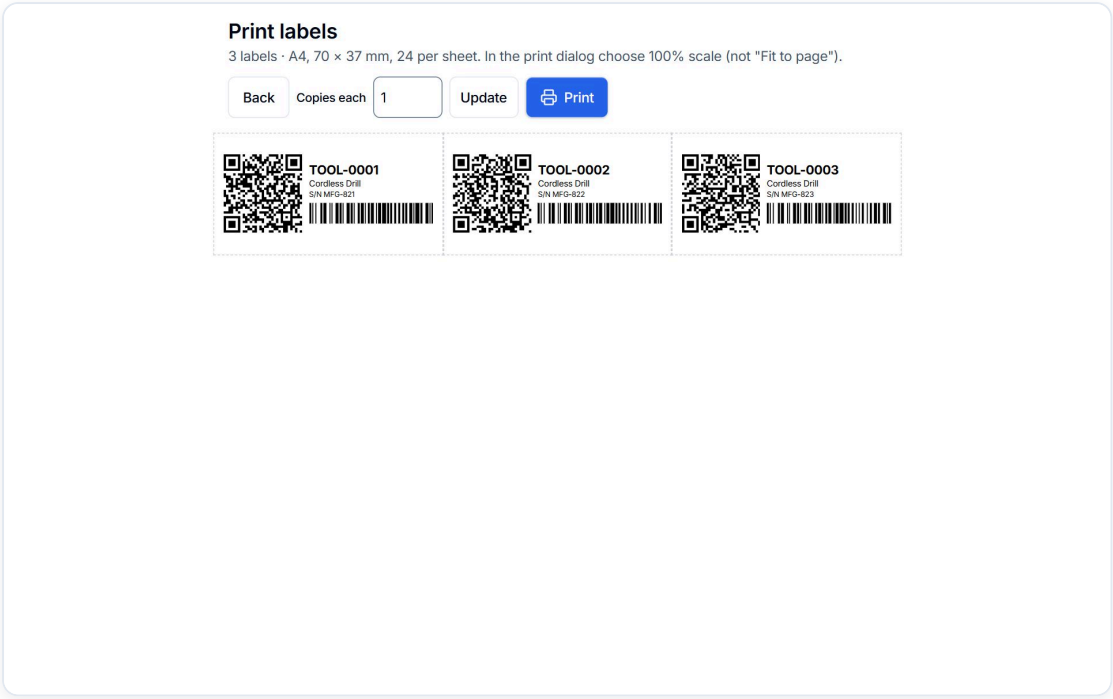



Stock list

## 10. Print labels

- **One item:** open the item → **Print label**.
- **One asset:** open the asset → **Print label**.
- **Many assets: Assets** → search or filter → **Print labels for this page**.

On the label page, set **Copies each** if you need more than one (press **Update**), then press **Print**.




Label sheet ready to print

**Warning:** Use A4 label paper with 3 × 8 labels (70 × 37 mm). In the print window choose **100% scale**, not "Fit to page", or the labels won't line up.

PART 3

# Office: equipment

## 11. Add equipment (assets)

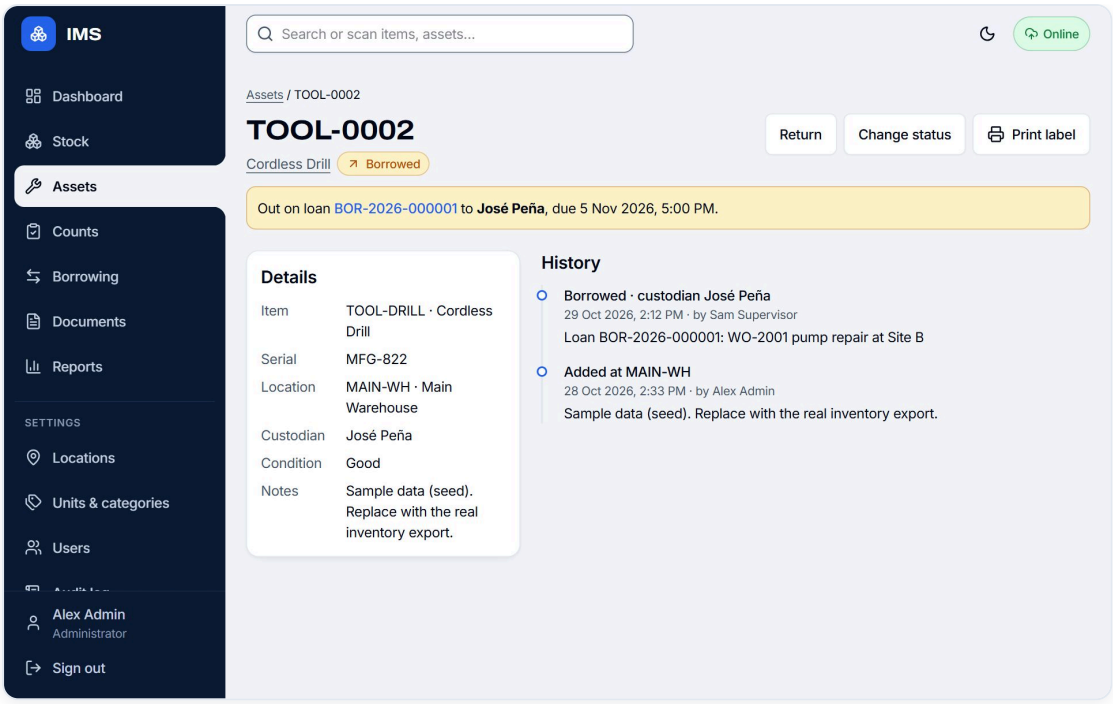
1. First make the item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset** (section 5).
2. Open **Assets** → **Add assets** (or open the item → **Add assets**).
3. **Asset item**: type the item's SKU and pick it.
4. **Location**: where it's kept.
5. **How many?**: one tag is made for each.
6. **Tag prefix**: a short code like `LAP`. Tags become LAP-0001, LAP-0002…
7. **Condition**: Good, Fair or Damaged.
8. Optional: **Serial numbers** (one per line, same order as the tags), **Custodian**, **Notes**.
9. Press **Add … assets**.
10. Press **Print … labels** and stick one label on each unit.

## 12. See or change one asset

Open **Assets** → tap the asset. You see its details and its full history.

The **Assets** list hides **Retired** equipment (the **Status** filter says **All except retired**). Choose **Retired** in **Status** to see it.

- **Borrow**: lend it (only when it's **Available**).
- **Return**: take it back (only when it's **Borrowed**).
- **Change status**: for example **Under maintenance**, **Needs review**, **Lost** or **Retired**. You must give a reason.
- **Print label**: reprint a lost or damaged label.



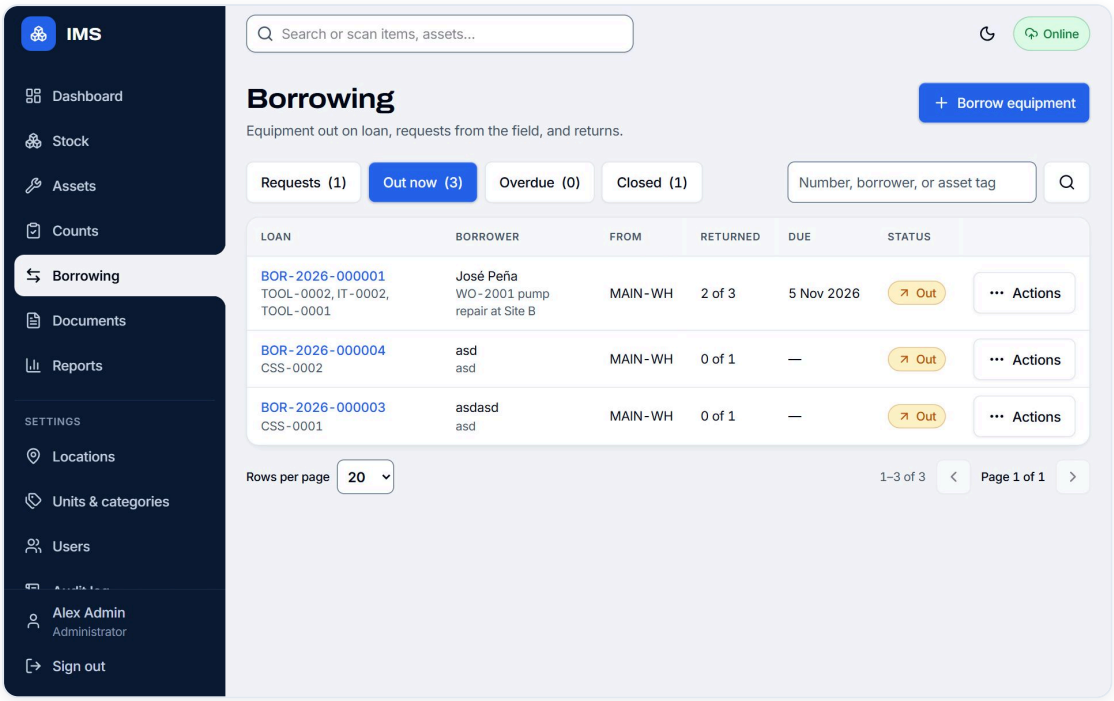

Asset page with history

| Status | Means | What can happen next |
|---|---|---|
| **Available** | Ready to lend | Borrow, or change status |
| **Borrowed** | Out on a loan | Return (or mark Lost) |
| **Under maintenance** | Being repaired | Back to Available when fixed |
| **Needs review** | Came back damaged, or a count found it | Check it, then Available or Under maintenance |
| **Lost** | Can't be found | If found: Needs review first |
| **Retired** | No longer used | Nothing (permanent) |

## 13. Lend equipment (Borrow)

1. **Borrowing** → **Borrow equipment**.
2. **Release from**: where the equipment is now → **Next**.
3. **Add asset**: scan or type each tag and press Enter. Set **Condition** and **Accessories** (like "charger, case") → **Next**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Due back**, **Physically received by**, **Notes** → **Next**.
5. Check everything. Optional: **Prepared by** (who got the equipment ready; leave it empty to use your name). **Preview form (DRAFT)** shows the form before anything is saved.
6. **Confirm release**.
7. Print the **Equipment Borrowing form** and have the borrower sign it.

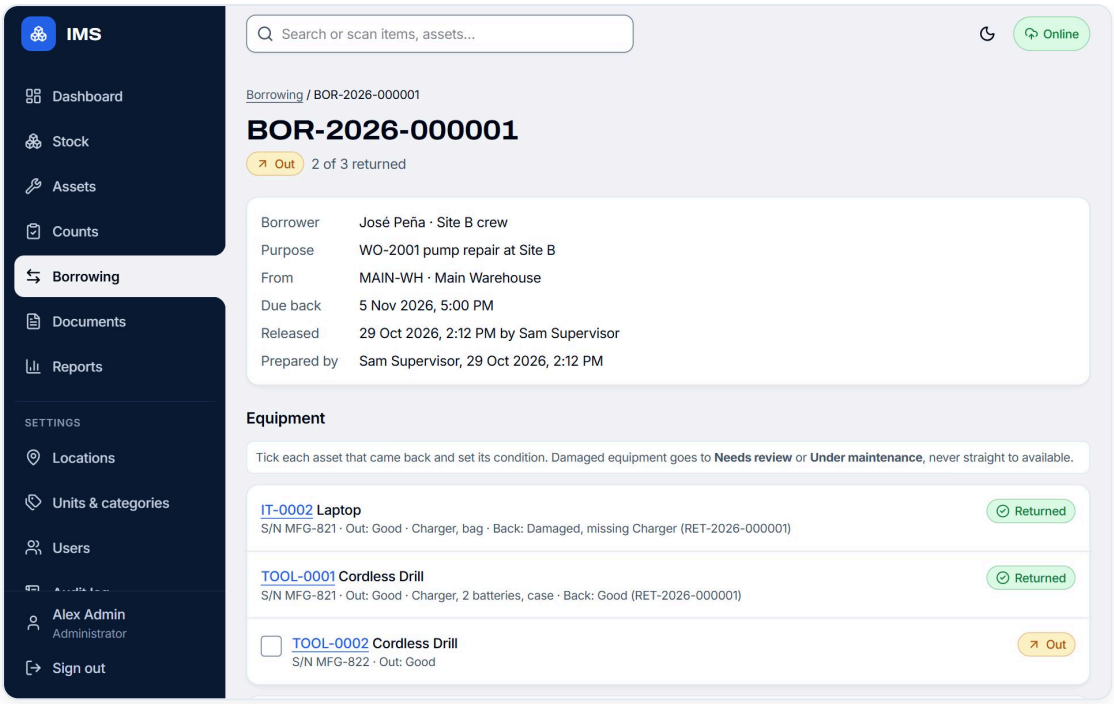
The **Borrowing** page has tabs: **Requests** (from field staff), **Out now**, **Overdue** (red) and **Closed**.




Borrowing list

## 14. Take equipment back (Return)

1. **Borrowing** → open the loan → **Return equipment**.
2. Tick each asset that came back.
3. **Condition now** for each. If it's **Damaged**, pick **Send to**: **Needs review** or **Under maintenance**.
4. Optional: **Missing accessories**, **Notes**.
5. **Brought back by** and **Received at**.
6. **Confirm return**, then print the **Return Acknowledgment**.




Loan page: tick what came back

**Tip:** You can return some items now and the rest later. The loan stays open until everything is back.

## 15. Release a borrow request from the field

1. **Borrowing** → **Requests** tab.
2. Open the request → **Check and release**.
3. Check the assets and details, then **Confirm release** as in section 13.

PART 4

# Office: stock counts

## 16. Start a count

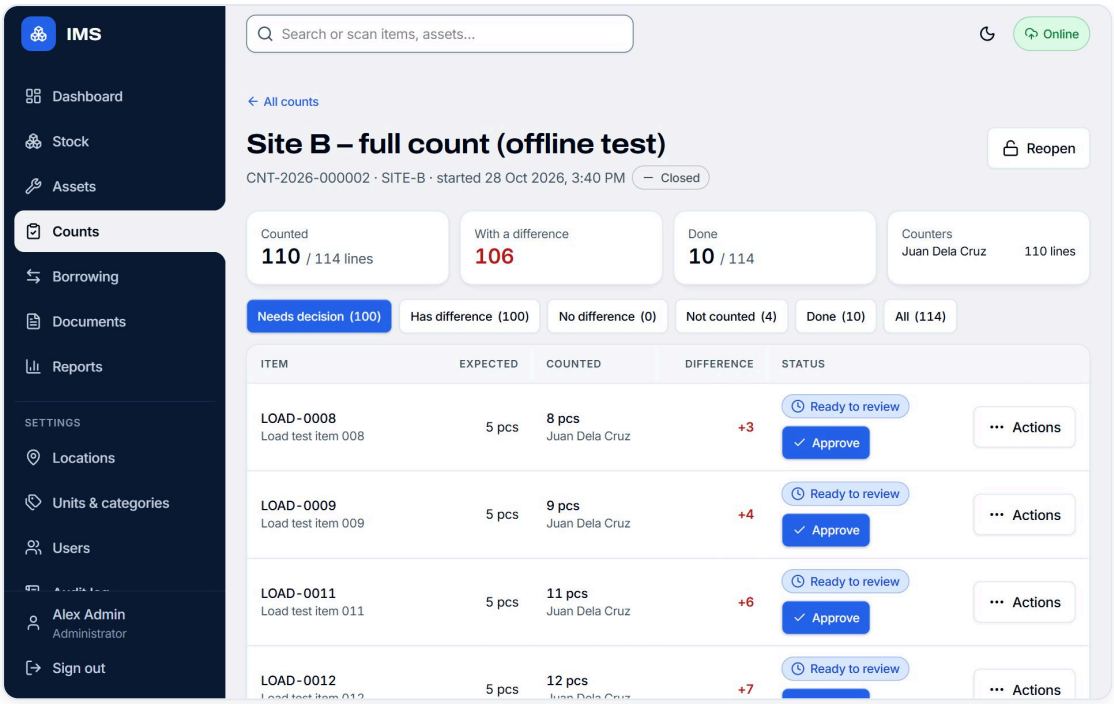
1. **Counts** → **New count**.
2. **Location to count** and a **Name** → **Next**.
3. **Count**: **Stock quantities** and/or **Tagged assets**. **Which items**: everything, or only some categories → **Next**.
4. **Who counts**: tick the people → **Next**.
5. Optional: **Finish counting by** and **Instructions for counters** → **Next**.
6. **Create count**.

The counters see it on their phones (section 25).

> **Warning:** While a count is open, stock at that location can't be received, issued or moved, so the numbers stay still. A supervisor can still do it by typing a **Reason for moving stock during the count**; those lines then need a recount.

## 17. Review and close a count

1. **Counts** → open the count. Each line shows what IMS expected and what was counted.
2. For each line:
   - **Approve**: set the stock to the counted number.
   - **Request recount** (in the line's menu): ask for it to be counted again.
   - **Keep expected** (in the line's menu): ignore the counted number.
3. **Approve … with no difference** approves every line that already matches, in one go.
4. When every line is decided → **Close count**. (**Reopen** undoes a close.)



Count review: expected vs counted

**Tip:** Counting alone never changes stock. Only **Approve** does, and it records an adjustment (ADJ-...) with your name. If two people counted the same thing differently, IMS asks you which count is right.

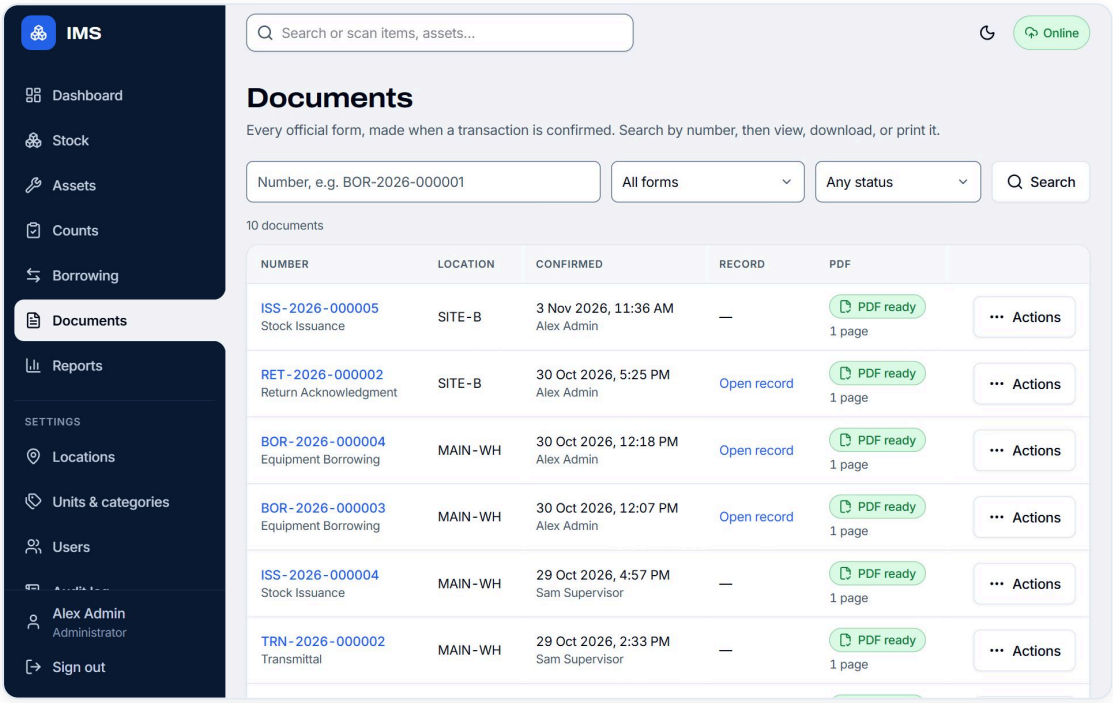
PART 5

# Forms, reports and settings

## 18. Forms (Documents)

IMS makes 4 forms: **Stock Issuance**, **Transmittal** (transfers), **Equipment Borrowing** and **Return Acknowledgment**.

1. Open **Documents**.
2. Search by number (like `ISS-2026-000123`) or filter by form.
3. **View**, **Download PDF** or **Print**.

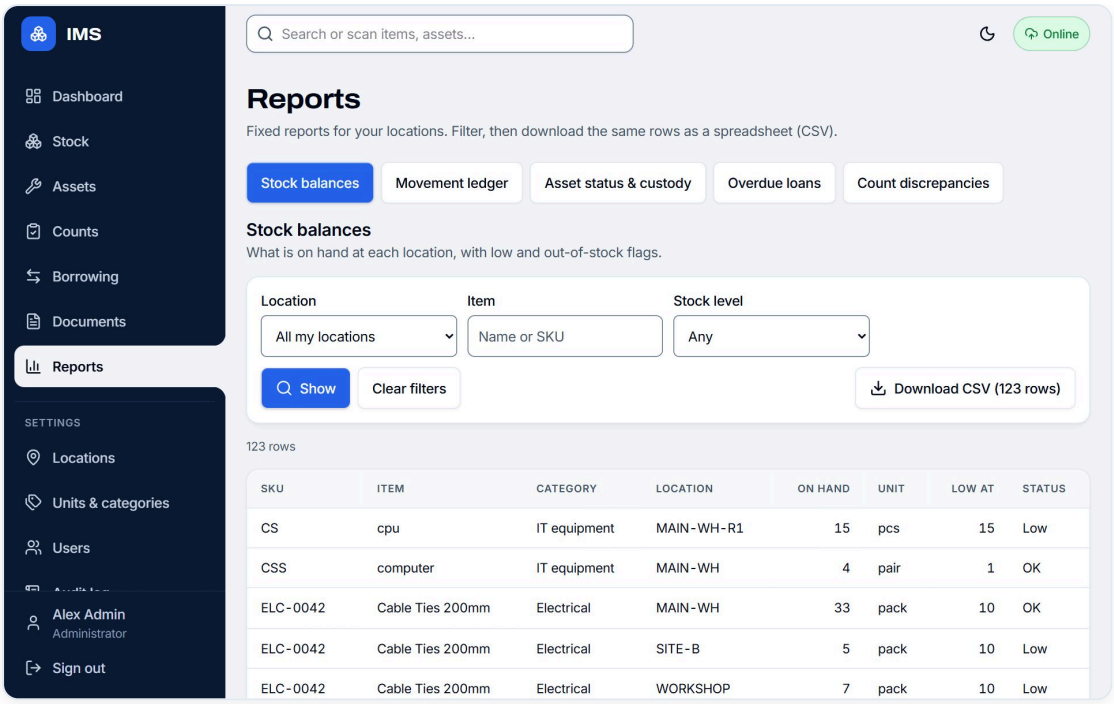



Documents list

**Tip:** If a form says "PDF failed", press **Retry PDF**. The stock or loan is already saved; this only remakes the form.

## 19. Reports

1. Open **Reports** and pick one: **Stock balances**, **Movement ledger**, **Asset status & custody**, **Overdue loans** or **Count discrepancies**.
2. Set the filters (location, dates, item...).
3. Page through the rows on screen, or **Download CSV** to get every row in Excel.

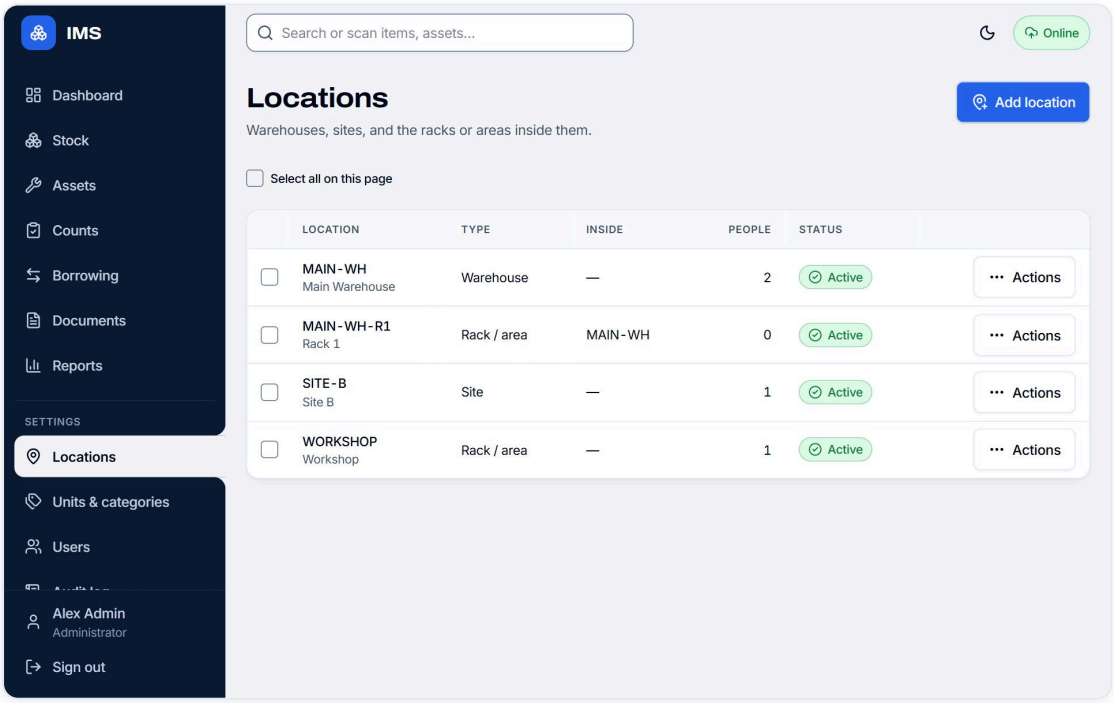



Reports

## 20. Locations

1. Open **Locations** → **Add location**.
2. **Code** (short and unique, like `WH-A` or `SITE-B-R1`), **Name**, **Type** (**Warehouse**, **Site** or **Rack / area**) and **Inside** (the location it belongs to, or **Top level (no parent)**).
3. Save.

Each row's menu has **Edit** and **Deactivate**. Codes can't be changed, because labels and forms use them.




Locations

## 21. Units & categories

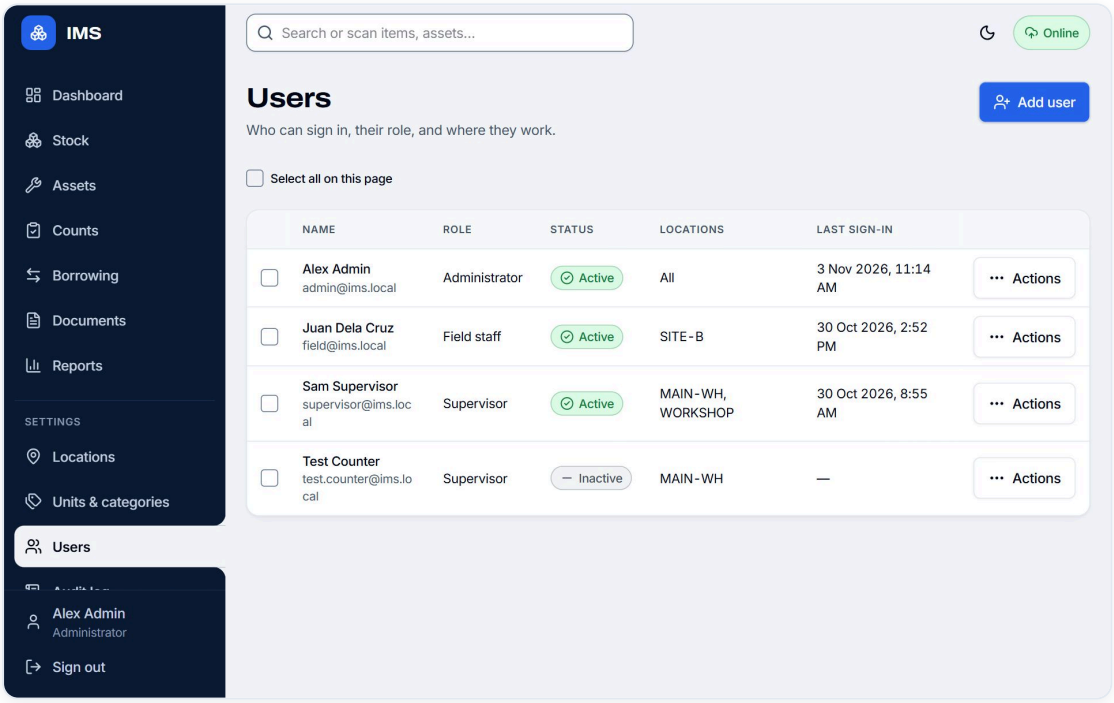
Open **Units & categories**:

- **Units**: type a **Code** (like `pcs`) and **Name** (like `Piece`) → **Add unit**.
- **Categories**: type a **Name** (like `PPE`) → **Add category**.

## 22. Users (administrators only)

1. Open **Users** → **Add user**.
2. **Full name**, **Email**, **Temporary password** (give it to the person directly, never by group chat).
3. **Role**: **Field staff**, **Supervisor** or **Administrator**.
4. **Locations**: pick where they work, with **Full** or **View only** access. Access includes everything inside a location.
5. Press **Add user**.

Each user's menu has **Edit**, **Reset link** and **Deactivate**. Deactivating signs the person out everywhere.




Users

## 23. Audit log (administrators only)

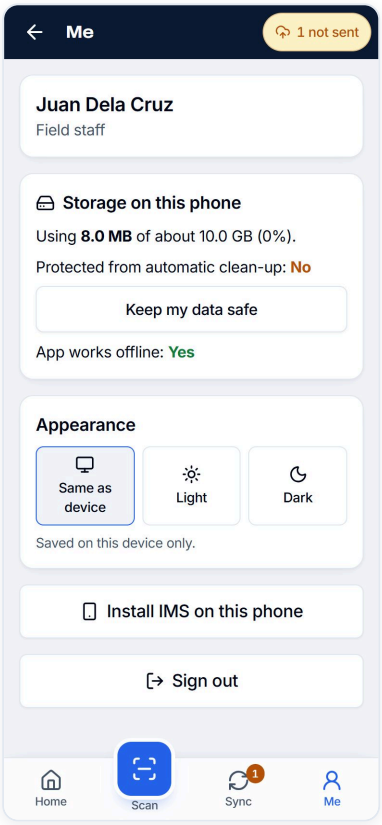
**Audit log** shows who did what and when: sign-ins, stock moves, approvals, changes to items, users and photos. No one can edit or delete entries in IMS.

PART 6

# Phone: field staff

## 24. First time (needs internet)

1. Open the IMS link on your phone and sign in.
2. **Me** → **Install IMS on this phone** → follow the steps for Android or iPhone. (On iPhone: Share → **Add to Home Screen**.)
3. From now on, open IMS from the new icon on your home screen.

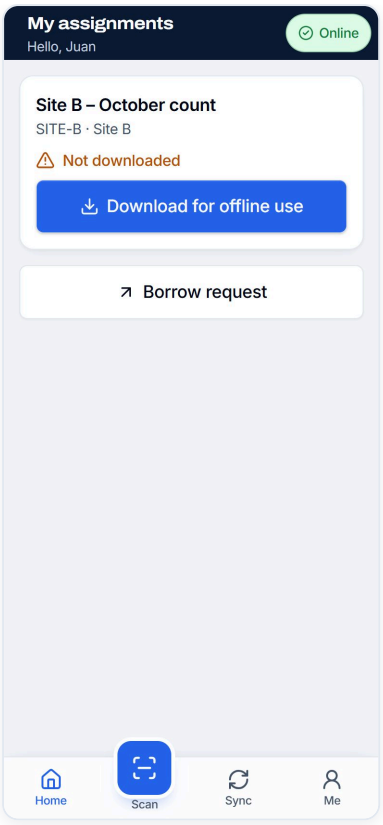



Me: install, storage, appearance

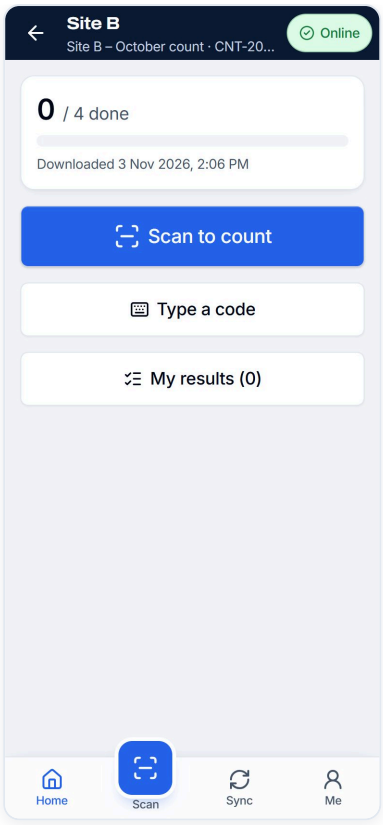
**Warning:** On iPhone the home-screen app keeps its own storage. Download your assignment again after installing.

## 25. Before you go out (needs internet)

1. **Home** → find your assignment.
2. Press **Download for offline use**.
3. Wait for **Ready for offline use**. Now it works without signal.



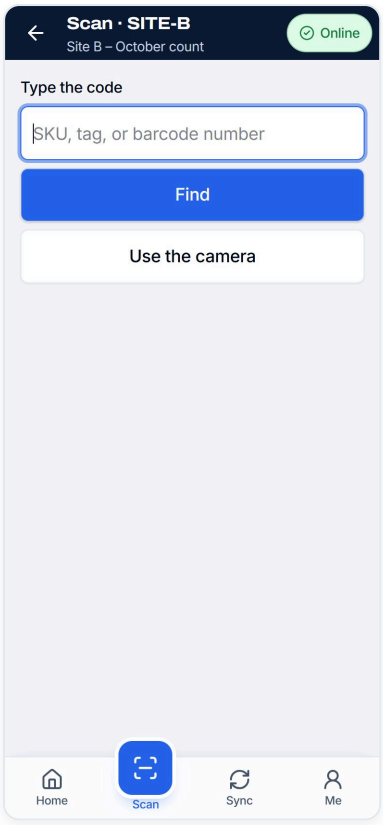

Home: download your assignment



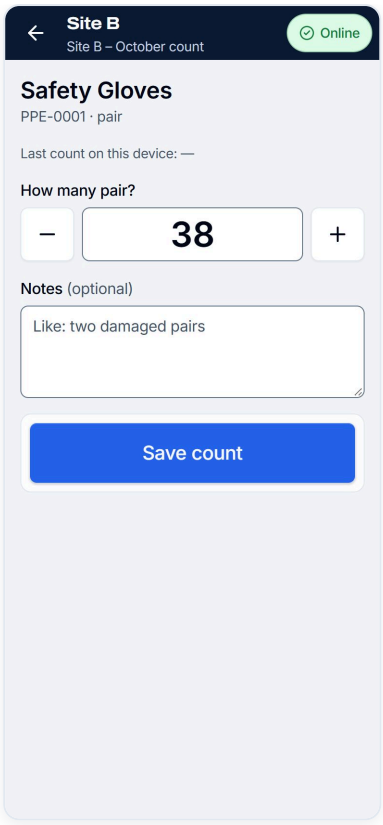

Assignment: scan to count

## 26. Count

1. Open the assignment → **Scan to count**.
2. Point the camera at the label. Camera not working? Press **Type a code**.
3. **Stock item:** type how many → **Save count**.
4. **Equipment:** tap **Found** or **Not found**. If found, pick the condition → **Save check**.
5. Scan the next one.




Type a code




Count screen: how many, then Save count

**Tip:** Scanned the same thing twice? It opens your saved count. It does **not** add it again.

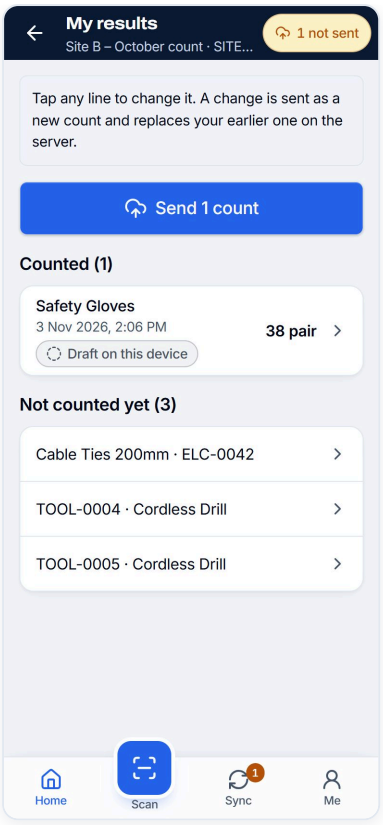
## 27. Check and fix your counts (My results)

1. Open the assignment → **My results**.
2. **Counted** and **Not counted yet** show your progress.
3. Tap any line to change it, then save again.

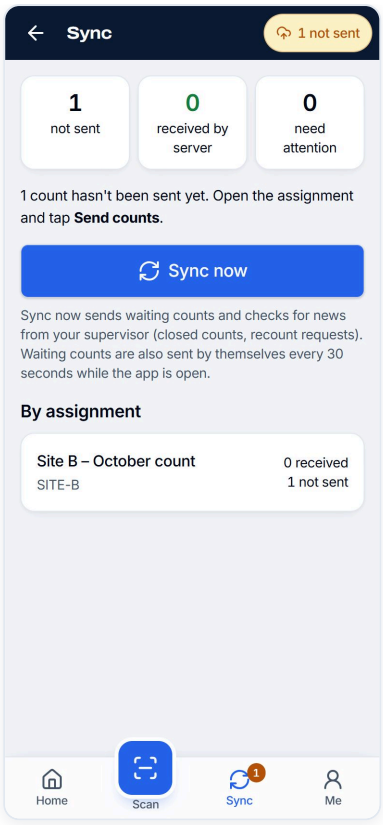
## 28. Send your counts (needs internet)

1. Open the assignment or **My results**.
2. Press **Send … counts** (like **Send 3 counts**).

The pill at the top shows where your counts are: **3 not sent** means still on your phone; **All sent** means the office has them.




My results: Send counts

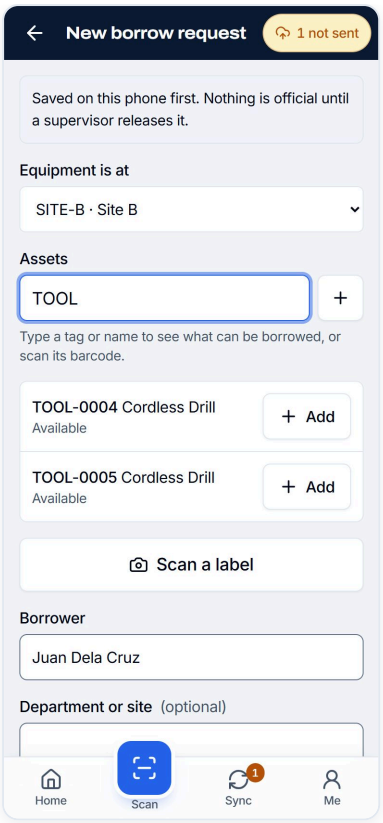



Sync screen

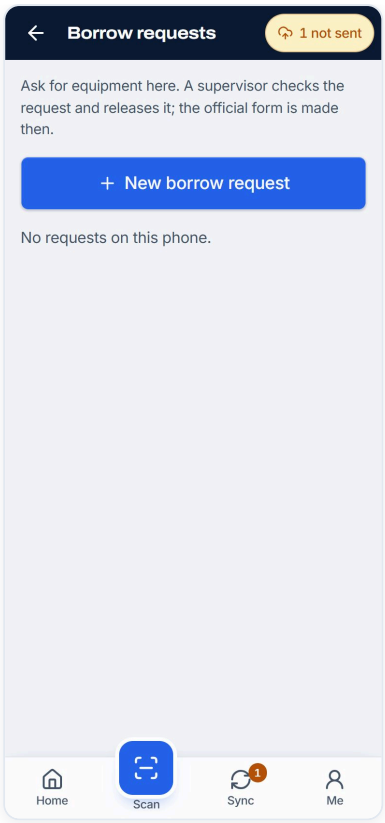
**Tip:** No signal? Your counts stay safe on the phone. Send them later from **Sync** → **Sync now**.

## 29. Ask to borrow equipment

1. **Home** → **Borrow request** → **New borrow request**.
2. **Equipment is at**: pick the location.
3. **Assets**: type a tag or name. Matching equipment appears; tap **Add** on one marked **Available**. Red text means it can't be borrowed (already out, under maintenance...) or isn't at that location. You can also **Scan a label**.
4. **Borrower** and **Purpose**. Optional: **Department or site**, **Notes**.
5. **Save on this phone**.
6. **Send to supervisor** (needs internet).




New borrow request: asset suggestions




Borrow requests

It's only a request. A supervisor checks it and does the official release.

## 30. Me

- **Appearance**: **Same as device**, **Light** or **Dark**.
- **Storage on this phone**: how much space IMS uses.
- **Install IMS on this phone**.
- **Sign out**. If you have counts that aren't sent, IMS warns you first. Signing out needs internet.

PART 7

# Quick reference

## 31. I want to...

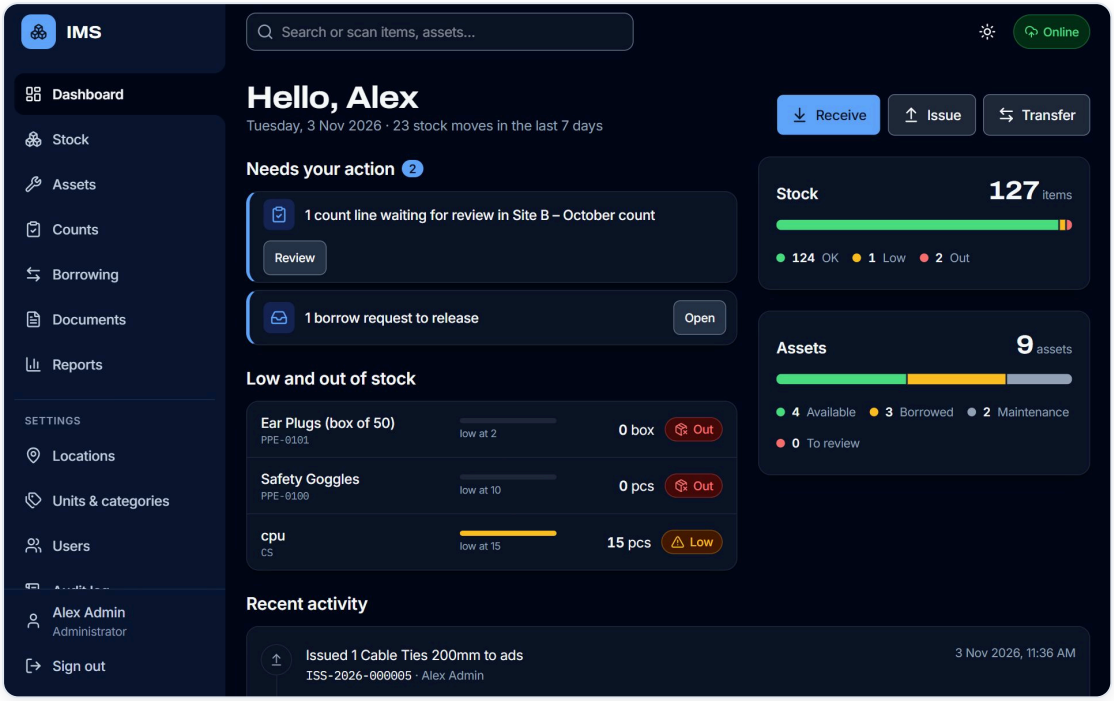
| I want to... | Go to |
|---|---|
| Add stock from a delivery | **Dashboard → Receive** |
| Give stock to someone | **Dashboard → Issue** |
| Use something up (bond paper) | Open the item → **Use** |
| Move stock between locations | **Dashboard → Transfer** |
| Add a new kind of item | **Stock → Add item** |
| Add many items | **Stock → Import CSV** |
| Tag new equipment | **Assets → Add assets** |
| Lend equipment | **Borrowing → Borrow equipment** |
| Take equipment back | **Borrowing** → open the loan → **Return equipment** |
| Count a location | **Counts → New count** |
| Find an item, asset or location | Search box, or **Scan → Type code instead** |
| Remove something added by mistake | Tick it in the list → **Delete selected** |
| Print labels | Item or asset → **Print label** |
| Reprint a form | **Documents** |
| Get a spreadsheet | **Reports → Download CSV** |
| Add a person | **Users → Add user** |
| Count with my phone | **Home → Download for offline use → Scan to count** |

## 32. What the colors mean

| Color | Means |
|---|---|
| Green | OK · Available · Done · All sent |
| Orange | Low stock · Borrowed · Not sent yet |
| Red | Out of stock · Overdue · Problem, needs action |

| Color | Means |
|---|---|
| Grey | Inactive · Retired · Draft |

Dark mode: tap the sun / moon button at the top, or **Me** → **Appearance**.




Dashboard in dark mode

## 33. Problems

| Problem | Do this |
|---|---|
| Added something by mistake | Tick it in the list (**Stock**, **Assets**, **Locations** or **Users**) → **Delete selected**. Never-used records are deleted; used ones are hidden so their history stays. Assets are retired. |
| "Too many wrong attempts" | Wait 15 minutes, or ask an administrator for a **Reset link** |
| "... is counted stock, not an asset item" | That item is Stock. Make a new item with **How is it tracked?** = **Asset** |
| No **Add assets** button on an item | The item is Stock. Use **Receive** for it, or make a new Asset item |
| "Only 3 left" when issuing | Lower the quantity or pick another location |
| Stock moves are blocked at a location | A count is open there. Finish it, or give a reason to move stock during the count |
| Asset can't be borrowed | It's borrowed, under maintenance, lost or retired. Check its status on **Assets** |

| Problem | Do this |
|---|---|
| A retired asset isn't in the list | **Assets** → **Status** → **Retired** |
| "PDF failed" | **Documents** → **Retry PDF** |
| CSV rows are red | Read the reason on each row; often the unit or category doesn't exist yet |
| Labels don't line up | Print at **100% scale** on 3 × 8 (70 × 37 mm) A4 label paper |
| Camera won't open | Allow the camera for IMS in the phone settings, or use **Type a code** |
| "Not downloaded" | Get internet, then **Download for offline use** |
| Counts stuck on "not sent" | Get internet → **Sync** → **Sync now** |

## 34. Don't

- **Don't clear browser data or uninstall IMS** while counts are not sent. Unsent counts would be lost.
- **Don't share your account.** Everything you do is recorded under your name.
- **Don't go out of signal without downloading** your assignment first.

## 35. Words used in IMS

| Word | Means |
|---|---|
| **SKU** | The item's unique code, like `PPE-0001` |
| **Asset tag** | One piece of equipment's unique code, like `TOOL-0001` |
| **Location** | A warehouse, site, or rack / area inside one |
| **Receive** | Stock coming in |
| **Issue** | Stock going out, not coming back |
| **Transfer** | Stock moving between two locations |
| **Borrow / Return** | Equipment going out and coming back |
| **Custodian** | The person responsible for a piece of equipment |
| **Count** | Checking what is really on the shelf against what IMS says |
| **Adjustment** | The change to stock when a count difference is approved (ADJ-...) |
| **Low-stock level** | When on-hand stock falls to this number, IMS shows it as Low |